

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Saul D. Bid

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Saul D. Bid

Chairman of Gavel & Rowe Auction House

Saul cannot ask someone to pass the salt without opening bidding. Saul has sold paintings, antiques, estates, scandals, and at least one chair that required its own insurance rider.

- Longtime professional rival of **Hugh Bidder**.

ACTING TIPS

Old-school charm, status-aware, patient, competitive. Speak as if the room has already agreed you belong in it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Saul D. Bid. Going once, going twice—no, I am only asking someone to pass the bread.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Saul D. Bid

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant threatened to expose a private sale you arranged outside your auction house's normal process unless you waived a substantial fee.

Your other secret

You did route the sale through a discreet subsidiary to satisfy a client who insisted on anonymity.

Conversations to start

- Compare notes with Hugh Bidder about Grant's demands on auction houses.
- Ask Elon Mosaic what he expects from tonight's unveiling. Keep your private sale to yourself for now.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A screen steals every eye. The evidence has slipped out of view behind it.*
- 2 *The award has already been won. Its underside offers another reward.*
- 3 *The clue is keeping company with the lamp in green.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Saul D. Bid

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Saul D. Bid

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I routed the sale through a subsidiary. The client demanded discretion, and I supplied a discreet invoice with an indiscreet fee. Grant threatened to expose the arrangement unless I waived that fee. He admired confidentiality until someone charged him for it.

IF MURDERER

The subsidiary sale was mine. Grant wanted the fee waived and the arrangement buried. Otherwise he would announce it tonight as my personal scandal. I have auctioned many ugly objects. His proposal had particularly poor proportions.



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Saul D. Bid

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Saul D. Bid

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I disclosed my client's ceiling price in a private auction call. Grant used it to demand that I waive the commission. I tried to arrange an off-book fee through the subsidiary instead. The client was not told. I spent the reception switching between that call and the bidding conversation, hoping to close the sale before either party compared notes. My service to the client was becoming expensive in ways the client had not authorized.

IF MURDERER

I disclosed my client's ceiling price in a private auction call. Grant used it to demand that I waive the commission. I tried to arrange an off-book fee through the subsidiary instead. The client was not told. I spent the reception switching between that call and the bidding conversation, hoping to close the sale before either party compared notes. My service to the client was becoming expensive in ways the client had not authorized.



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Saul D. Bid

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Saul D. Bid

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

My client gave me a ceiling price in writing. I disclosed it to Grant against instructions. The sale book and the client's original message establish the transaction I was trying to rescue. I have made a client's negotiating position considerably worse. Turning that mistake into a murder accusation will not improve it.

IF MURDERER

I disclosed my client's ceiling price to Grant. The folded sheet was supposed to repair the resulting fee dispute. Grant now knew which part of the sale I could not afford to have described honestly. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my sale book. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass out of the way of the private fee statement.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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Saul D. Bid

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Saul D. Bid

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I disclosed the client's ceiling and tried to hide the resulting fee through a subsidiary. The original message and sale book establish it. I did not murder Grant. The client will receive both. I may find myself negotiating my own refund, which will be a less enjoyable auction than the one I intended to conduct tonight.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my sale book when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He wanted my fee waived and my client exposed. I made a private commission the excuse for murder.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.
